



1274-1329 ROBERT THE BRUCE

King of the Scots from 1306, Robert was a formidable warrior. After defeating English King Edward II in 1314 he raided into England and established Scotland's right to be an independent kingdom.

1314 Robert the Bruce leads Scotland into victory against the English at the Battle of Bannockburn

▷ Maori chevron pendant made of whale ivory



c.1320 MAORI COLONIZE NEW ZEALAND

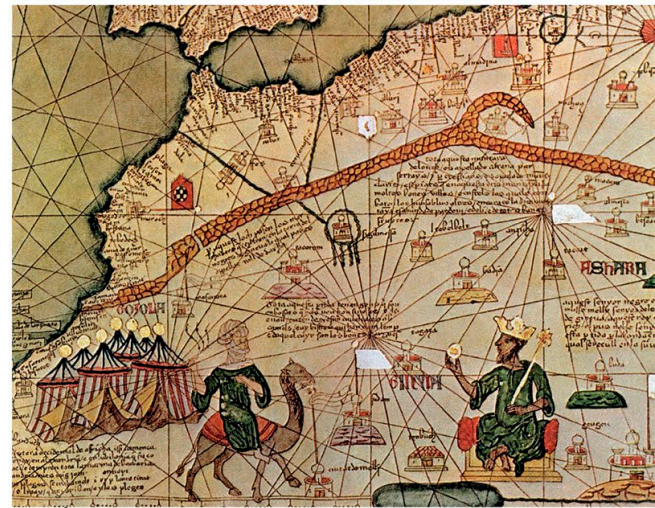
Although the date can never be known for certain, it was probably around 1320 that the first major wave of Polynesian settlers, now known as Maori, arrived in previously unpopulated New Zealand. They are thought to have voyaged in canoes some 4,000 km (2,500 miles) across the South Pacific from the Society Islands. Once established, the Maori developed a unique culture and social system that remained largely undisturbed by outside contact until the 19th century.

1324

▽ Mansa Musa depicted on a Catalan chart

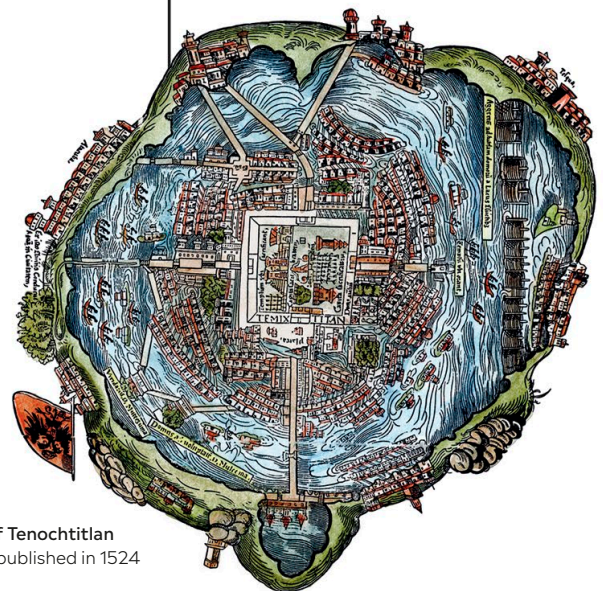
PILGRIMAGE OF MANSA MUSA

In 1324, Mansa Musa, ruler of the Muslim Mali empire in West Africa, embarked on a pilgrimage to Mecca. His arrival in Cairo, then the greatest city in the Muslim world, caused a sensation. No one had seen the equal of his richly clad retinue and his vast wealth in gold. When Musa returned to Mali from his pilgrimage he built fine mosques, colleges, and libraries in cities such as Timbuktu and Gao, making his empire a leading centre of Islamic faith and learning.



1324 Death of Osman, founder of the Turkish Ottoman dynasty

1329



▷ Map of Tenochtitlan published in 1524

1325

AZTECS FOUND TENOCHTITLAN

In 1325, the wandering Aztec (or Mexica) people settled on a swampy island in Lake Texcoco, in what is now Mexico City. They chose the site as fulfilling a prophesied vision of an eagle perched on a cactus. This settlement later grew to be the largest city in Mesoamerica and hub of a powerful empire.